

Course 5 — Building a Trading Strategy

Curriculum Document

Level: Intermediate

Prerequisite: Trading 101 → Chart Reading 101 → Reading the Market → The Language of Price

Goal: Teach students to convert analysis into a structured, repeatable trading approach.

Positioning: From “I understand the market” → “I can build a structured trading approach.”

Course Overview

Module	Topic	What Students Learn
1	What Makes a Trading Strategy?	What a strategy is and how it differs from random trading
2	Finding a Trading Opportunity	A basic framework for identifying potential opportunities in the market
3	Entry Conditions	Which conditions should be satisfied before entering a trade
4	Exit Conditions	When to close a trade and why defining the exit in advance is important
5	Stop Loss & Protection	The purpose of a stop loss and a basic approach to protecting a trade from downside
6	Risk & Reward	Comparing potential loss against potential profit
7	Position Size Basics	The basic concept of how much capital to expose in a single trade
8	Trade Setup & Rules	Clearly defining entry, exit, invalidation, and conditions
9	Simple Strategy Examples	Understanding basic strategy ideas such as trend-following, breakout, and pullback
10	When Not to Trade	Identifying poor setups, unclear conditions, and unsuitable market situations
11	Testing a Strategy	The basic process of manually testing a strategy on historical charts
12	Keeping a Trading Journal	Recording trades, noting observations, and identifying mistakes
13	Strategy Lab	Students execute and review simulated trades according to their own rules
14	Build Your First Strategy	The student creates a complete beginner-level trading strategy

The Main Shift in This Course

BEFORE, THE STUDENT WOULD SAY

“I think price might go up.”

NOW, THE STUDENT SHOULD BE ABLE TO SAY

“According to my strategy, I will consider a trade when condition X is met, entry will be at Y, invalidation will be at Z, and risk is defined in advance.”

In other words: prediction-based thinking → rule-based thinking.

Important Interactive Features for Chart Coach

Strategy Builder

The student is given blocks/fields to fill in:

Market Condition → Setup → Entry → Stop Loss → Target → Exit Rule

Historical Replay

The past market is hidden and the student is asked: “Does a trade form here according to your strategy?” The market is then revealed.

AI Strategy Review

The AI checks the student's strategy for:

- Whether the rules are clear
- Whether the conditions are contradictory
- Whether the strategy can be applied consistently
- Where the ambiguity lies

Simulated Trading Challenge

The student is given fixed market scenarios and must make decisions according to their strategy.

What This Course Does Not Cover Yet

This course does not go into advanced algorithmic strategies, options strategies, leverage-heavy systems, high-frequency trading, complex quantitative models, or institutional-level execution.

These belong in later, advanced tracks.

Core Outcome

After completing the course, the student:

By the end of the course, the student can understand, structure, test, and apply a basic, clearly defined trading strategy in a simulated environment — and evaluate their decisions on the basis of predefined rules.